

THE PAPAYA TREE
AHANGAMA · SRI LANKA



A GUIDE TO THE SOUTH COAST

The Ahangama Guide

Everything we'd tell a friend

SURF

EAT

EXPLORE

REST

WELCOME

Everything we'd tell a friend

We live here. This is the guide we wish we'd had: where the waves break, where to eat, and what is worth the drive. Yours to keep, whether you book or not.

Sri Lanka opens slowly, one temple shade and one long lunch at a time.

AHANGAMA · SRI LANKA

2 min

to the surf

3 min

to town

30 min

to Galle Fort

Nov–Apr

surf season

-
- | | | |
|----|---------------------|----------------------------|
| 01 | Surf & fitness | Breaks, seasons, yoga |
| 02 | Eat & drink | Our honest shortlist |
| 03 | Things to do | Small days, well spent |
| 04 | Day trips | Forts, whales, tea, safari |
| 05 | Getting here | And getting around |
| 06 | Good things to know | Practical bits |
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Ten breaks, fifteen *minutes*

From a first lesson in the white water at Kabalana to the reef at The Rock, the south coast surf sits within a short tuk-tuk of the garden. Season runs November to April.

2 min

Ahangama, reef and beach

Kabalana's sandy beach break welcomes every level, with faster reef peaks close by for when you're ready to push further: The Rock, Marshmallows, Gas Station and Sticks.

10 min

Midigama

Lazy Left, Lazy Right, Rams and Plantations, a row of reef breaks for surfers with a few sessions behind them.

15 min

Weligama Bay

The best bay on the coast for beginner and intermediate surfers, a big sandy break with a gentler reef at its edges.

Warm all year, best from *November to April*

NOVEMBER

Opening

Weather	Warm
Temp	29°C
Swell	Building

DECEMBER TO MARCH

Prime

Weather	Hot & dry
Temp	30°C
Swell	Consistent

APRIL

Easing

Weather	Warm
Temp	28°C
Swell	Fading

MAY TO OCTOBER

Green season

Weather	Warm & humid
Temp	27°C
Swell	Flat

Move well, *rest easy*

If you are looking for a yoga, pilates or fitness studio during your stay, here are the ones we recommend nearby.

01 Yoga

Tahini and Friends, The Well, Yoga Ahangama: three easy places for a morning class, all a short tuk-tuk away.

02 Fitness

Loka Lanka Fitness, for a proper gym session if you want to keep training while you are here.

03 Pilates

Pura Pilates, a reformer pilates studio a short ride from the house.

Where we actually *eat*

Breakfast and easy plates happen right here, in our own restaurant, with a rooftop bar for the sunset. But this stretch of coast has some of the best food on the island too. Here is our honest shortlist.

At the house

Our own restaurant

Breakfast and easy plates on the ground floor, whenever you don't feel like going out.

The rooftop bar

A cold drink and a good view for the sunset, right upstairs.

In Ahangama

Food City, the grocery shop opposite Ceylon Sliders, covers anything you need day to day.

Ceylon Sliders

Brunch and dinner, and the Saturday sunset sessions once the season picks up.

Crust Ahangama

Wood-fired pizza and good drinks.

Moochies

Easy, unfussy breakfast and brunch.

Hotel De Uncle's

A beach bar built for sunset drinks.

Cocos Kitchen

Local and western plates, side by side.

Thelenis

Dinner with your feet almost in the sand.

Cafe Ceylon

A quiet coffee by the pool.

Odara

Local food and snacks, kept simple.

Kamburugamuwa, 5 min past Mirissa

Zephyr Ceylon

Beachfront, with an unusual fusion menu worth the detour.

Mirissa, on the beach

Petti Petti

Pool days and people watching, with events most weekends.

Paradise Beach Club

A big pool with food and drinks, though service can be slow.

Zouk, Central Beach, Mirissa Eye, Surf View

Casual, seafood-led restaurants right on the sand.

Mirissa, in town

Lost Paradise

A build-your-own brunch, meat options included.

Shady Lane

Vegetarian and stylish, a lovely brunch spot.

Milky Wave

Italian, pasta, gnocchi and gelato.

O Mirissa / Deltano's

The best pizza around, and a good rainy day plan.

No. 1 Dewmini Roti Shop

Cheap, honest rotis, fresh juice, and they teach a cooking class too.

Weligama and Polhena

Hangtime

Breakfast, lunch and dinner looking over Weligama Bay.

Dulnetha

Local rice and curry, done well.

Nomad

The best brunch in the south, by our count.

Kurumba Bay

Restaurants, bars, gelato, a pool and the beach in one place.

Kai Beach Club

A beachfront hangout with a pool.

The Doctors House

Live music on Saturdays, DJs on Wednesdays, fine dining upstairs.

Matara and Unawatuna

Matara Rest House

A colonial building with good local food and drinks.

The Dutchman Street

A cosy little beach cafe.

Skinny Tom's Deli

One of the best brunch spots on this stretch of coast.

Wild & The Sage

Cafe, bookshop and a book club, all in one.

Food to your door

Uber Eats and Sri Delivery

Cover most local restaurants, for the nights you'd rather stay in.

Small days, well *spent*

You do not need a packed itinerary here. A few gentle things close by, and a little more if you go looking for it.

Dawn

Stilt fishermen at Koggala

The old way of fishing, best in the soft early light before the day heats up.

Afternoon

Sauna and ice bath

A wood-fired sauna and cold plunge near the beach, for after a long surf.

Dusk

River safari

A quiet boat up the mangroves as the birds come in to roost.

Yoga and fitness

Tahini and Friends, The Well, Yoga Ahangama

Three easy places for a morning class, all a short ride away.

Loka Lanka Fitness

A proper gym session, if you want to keep training.

Pura Pilates

A reformer pilates studio.

Snorkel with turtles

Morning swim at Polhena

Go out with Aja, +94 774 220 007, to snorkel alongside green sea turtles close to shore.

Shopping and a little pampering

Hathu Roots

Jewellery, skincare, clothes and tattoos, in Ahangama.

Azure Swim and Azure Beauty

Swimwear and good sunscreen, plus manicures and pedicures, in Polhena.

Secret Root Spa

A relaxing massage in a peaceful garden, +94 773 294 332.

After dark, in Ahangama

Lamana

Skate sessions and parties, check their Instagram for what's on.

Trax

Drinks and dancing.

Worth the *drive*

When you feel like venturing further, the south coast opens onto forts, whales, tea hills and safari. All within a day of the garden.

30 min

Galle Fort

Dutch ramparts, cafes and little shops inside the old walls, and the easiest day trip for a wander and some shopping. Reach it by tuk-tuk or bus.

45 min

Whales off Mirissa

Blue whales and dolphins offshore from December to April, an early start but worth it.

2 hr

Tea country

Cool green hills, a tea estate and a slower pace, a long but memorable day.

2 hr

Yala safari

Leopards, elephants and buffalo in the national park to the east.

Mirissa's top five

Mirissa Main Beach

The easy, obvious one, and still the best for a swim.

Coconut Tree Hill

The view everyone comes for, best at sunrise or sunset.

Parrot Rock

A short climb for a wide view over the bay.

Secret Beach

A quieter cove tucked away from the main stretch.

Fisheries Harbour

Early morning boats and the day's catch coming in.

Finding the garden *gate*

Ahangama sits on the south coast, an easy drive or a slow scenic train from Colombo. Here is how most guests arrive.

Airport

From Colombo (CMB)

About 2 to 2.5 hours by car down the southern expressway. The easiest and most common route.

Airport

From Mattala (HRI)

About 1.5 hours from the smaller southern airport, when flights line up.

Train

The coastal line

A slow, beautiful train hugs the coast from Colombo to Ahangama station, a few minutes from the house.

On arrival

Getting around

Tuk-tuks are everywhere and cheap. The surf and the town are both about three minutes away.

A few things worth *knowing*

Getting around further

A driving permit

Tourists can get a temporary Sri Lankan driving permit right at Bandaranaike International Airport (BIA) in Colombo. The local outfit Tuktuk Rental can also arrange one for you.

PickMe and Uber

The cheaper option, though vehicles are limited in the south. The fastest way to get a ride in a hurry.

Buses

Frequent and affordable, especially the Galle to Matara route, a bus passes roughly every 10 minutes.

The AC highway bus

Runs from Bastian Mawatha station in Colombo straight down to Matara, a comfortable way to cover the distance.

Everyday things

Food City

The grocery shop opposite Ceylon Sliders, for anything you need day to day.

While you're here

Support the street dogs

Sri Lanka's streets have many stray dogs. If you'd like to help, follow and support @thedzikoproject, a local group doing good work for them.

SEE YOU SOON

Stay a while in the *garden*

Seven rooms around the pool, three minutes from the surf and the town.

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- Rooms from \$65 a night for a double
-
- Book direct for the best rate
-
- Free cancellation up to 5 days before check-in
-
- We reply fast, usually on WhatsApp

WHATSAPP

[+94 78 716 3242](https://wa.me/94787163242)

EMAIL

hello@thepapayatree.com

INSTAGRAM

[@thepapayatree_ahangama](https://www.instagram.com/thepapayatree_ahangama)

FIND US

Munidasa Mawatha, Ahangama 80650